

Fig. 11.3: Fatehabad segment of Ashokan pillar (the bottom part)

Keeping in mind this perspective, the intersection of the pillars and communication routes in this part of Bihar was highlighted by the archaeologist N.G. Majumdar. One of the routes, he showed, connected Lauriya with the area where the modern frontier station of Bhikhna Thori, leading to Narkatiaganj, stood; the other passed along the Gandak river to reach Triveni on the borderland, at the junction of the Gandak with two other streams.[12] Along the first route lay Rampurva with two of Ashoka's